

THE SESSION • POST-CLOSE READ

Oil Jumps, Chips Slide

The S&P 500 fell 0.46% and the Nasdaq 1.25% as Brent climbed to about \$103 a barrel and semiconductor stocks declined on rate and AI-financing concerns. Dividend Strategy +0.38% beat SPY and trailed DVY; Growth Portfolio -1.36% trailed IUSG.

S&P 500 ▼ 0.46% NASDAQ ▼ 1.25% DOW ▲ 0.10% VIX ▲ 3.32% BRENT ▲ \$103

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

▲ BEAT SPY • TRAILED DVY

+0.38%

1-DAY

FCI		+0.38%
DVY		+1.41%
SPY		-0.42%

YTD +17.59% vs DVY +12.77% • SPY +14.39%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

▼ TRAILED IUSG

-1.36%

1-DAY

FCI		-1.36%
IUSG		-1.19%

YTD +23.03% vs IUSG +17.29%

THE SESSION

Chip stocks led the market lower on Thursday as crude oil jumped. The S&P 500 fell 0.46% to 7,766 and the Nasdaq 1.25% to 27,195, while the Dow edged up 0.10% to 51,232; the VIX rose to 15.58. Technology was the weakest of the eleven S&P 500 sectors and energy led. NVIDIA, AMD, Marvell, Credo and TSMC each fell between 2.9% and 3.9% as concerns over higher rates and the cost of financing the AI buildout weighed on the group, and the prospect of Broadcom lining up about \$50 billion of financing for OpenAI sharpened that concern. Brent rose about 3% to roughly \$103 a barrel after trading above \$105 earlier in the session, as attacks on shipping in the Strait of Hormuz and a cut in U.S. output tied to hurricane activity renewed supply worries; the President said the U.S. would not strike Iran before the November 3 midterm elections. The official 10-year Treasury

yield was 5.22%, down from 5.28% on Wednesday. Governor Waller said more rate increases will probably be needed, with timing flexible, and futures pricing implied about a 68% chance of a December increase. IBIT fell 2.01% and ETHA 4.13%.

The Dividend Strategy rose 0.38%, ahead of SPY's 0.42% decline by 0.80 point and behind DVY's 1.41% gain by 1.03 points, with sixteen of twenty-five holdings higher. Constellation Energy was the largest drag, falling 4.85% to \$285.07 and subtracting about 0.35 point as investors took profits after Tuesday's gain of more than 12% on its nuclear power agreement with Google. Lam Research fell 2.71% and Caterpillar 2.18%, subtracting about 0.08 and 0.06 point. SS&C Technologies rose 2.48%, ADP 2.55% and S&P Global 1.91%, adding about 0.18, 0.16 and 0.10 point.

A rise in the cost of capital tends to test the most heavily financed corners of a market first. Owners of cash-generative businesses tend to be better positioned to absorb that rotation. Think Like an Owner.

The Growth Portfolio fell 1.36%, behind IUSG's 1.19% decline by 0.17 point, with eight of twenty-five holdings higher. Vistra was the largest drag, falling 6.33% to \$156.16 and subtracting about 0.38 point as independent power producers pulled back after Tuesday's rally. Hut 8 fell 10.87% and NVIDIA 2.94%, subtracting about 0.26 and 0.21 point.

ServiceNow rose 1.35%, Agnico Eagle 1.95% and Chevron 3.15%, adding about 0.13, 0.11 and 0.09 point as crude climbed. On the year, the Dividend Strategy stands at +17.59% against DVY's +12.77%, a +4.82-point spread, with SPY at +14.39%; the Growth Portfolio stands at +23.03% against IUSG's +17.29%, a +5.74-point spread.

FCI HOLDINGS • NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

CVX +3.15% GROWTH
Rose to \$211.61 as crude climbed and energy led the S&P 500 sectors.

PCAR +2.62% DIVIDEND
Rose to \$109.66 without a company-specific catalyst.

DECLINERS

HUT -10.87% GROWTH
Fell to \$79.59, the largest decline among FCI holdings, as bitcoin miners broadly lagged bitcoin.

VST -6.33% GROWTH
Fell to \$156.16 as independent power producers cooled after Tuesday's rally.

OKE +2.57% GROWTH
Rose to \$90.31 alongside the energy group as crude rose.

ADP +2.55% DIVIDEND
Rose to \$270.73 without a company-specific catalyst.

CEG -4.85% DIVIDEND
Fell to \$285.07 on profit-taking after Tuesday's gain of more than 12%.

MARA -4.34% GROWTH
Fell to \$9.91 as bitcoin miners lagged bitcoin.

YEAR-TO-DATE STANDING

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

+17.59%

vs DVY +12.77% / SPY +14.39%

Spread vs DVY **+4.82 pts**

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

+23.03%

vs IUSG +17.29%

Spread vs IUSG **+5.74 pts**

SOURCES

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